HEALTH-A-THON 2026 · CANCER TRACK · PATIENT FOLLOW-UP & CONTINUITY OF CARE

Saathi

A WhatsApp companion for families caring for palliative cancer patients at home, where every escalation follows the doctor’s own protocol.

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Families are far away, and the doctor cannot see between visits

7M+

Indians need palliative care each year

1–4%

of them can access it

~49%

of 911 listed palliative centres had morphine in stock

Distance

Patients travel from across Karnataka. Each visit costs a day’s wages and exhausts a bedbound patient.

Caregivers

Families struggle with oral morphine, fentanyl patches and spotting oversedation.

The doctor

Phone calls interrupt OPD and carry no objective history. Urgent problems surface late.

Sources: Lancet Commission on Global Access to Palliative Care and Pain Relief; Pallium India directory of palliative care services.

For families: a two-minute daily check-in

On WhatsApp, in Kannada, Hindi or English. Tap buttons or just send a voice note.

Daily check-in

Pain, rescue doses, drowsiness, breathing, vomiting, bowels, eating, confusion, and how the caregiver is coping.

Picture medicine chart

A photo of each medicine, audio reminders, and one tap for “Given” or “Extra dose given”.

Care cards with videos

Giving opioids, applying a fentanyl patch, counting breaths, checking drowsiness. All approved by the palliative physician.

Wound photos and a children’s pack

Guided wound photos for the doctor. For children, behavioural pain signs and a lower threshold to reach a doctor.

How a voice note becomes a doctor’s call

> *“Papa is very sleepy, he falls asleep while talking, and I gave the extra dose four times.”*
>
> Caregiver voice note in Hindi (example)

Speech to text

Sarvam or Bhashini transcribes and translates.

Fill the check-in

Drowsiness: falls asleep while talking. Rescue doses: 4. Her exact words kept.

Doctor’s protocol

Rules signed by the palliative physician match this report.

RED: on-call now

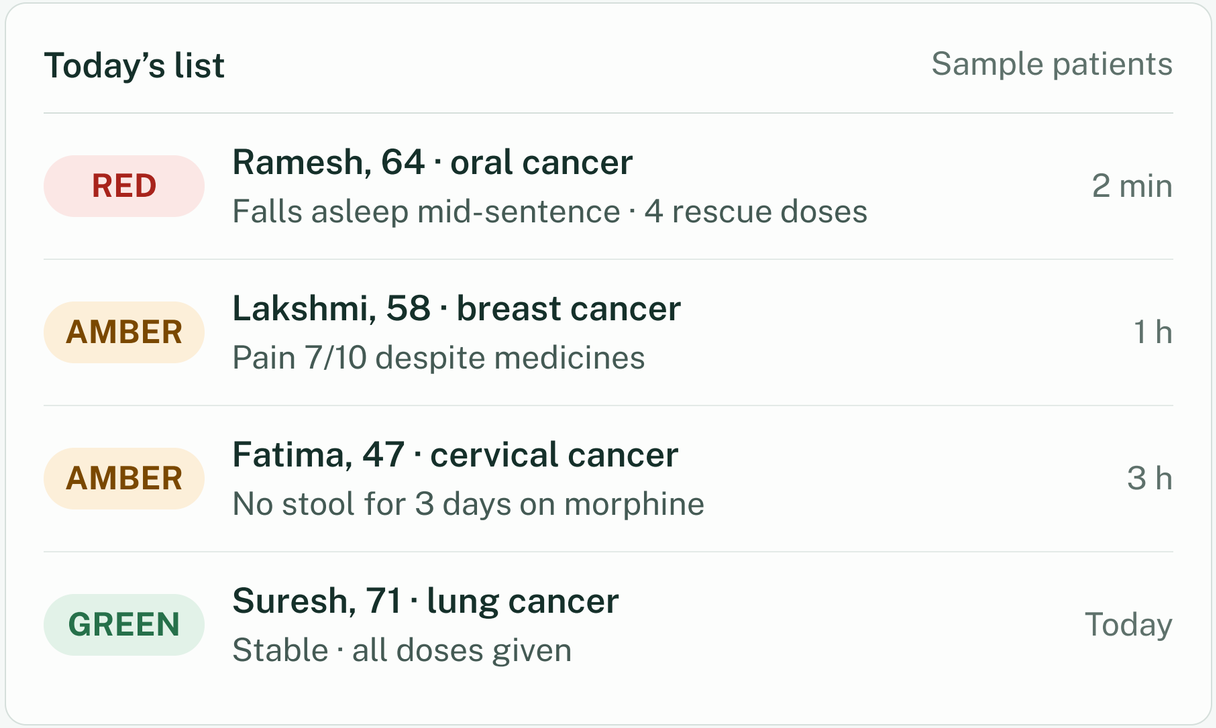
Doctor alerted in seconds. Family gets an approved message.

RED 24/7 on-call doctor, immediately

AMBER same-day review list

GREEN logged, approved care card sent

For the care team: one list, one timeline



Pre-call summary

What changed since the last contact, in the family’s own words.

OP, IP and home on one timeline

Pain, rescue doses, missed medicines and wound photos by date.

The doctor’s own assessments

Family-reported drowsiness beside the doctor’s RASS. A PPI worksheet the doctor signs at each visit.

Act in one tap

Call, video consult, e-prescription, or book a visit.

AI listens. The doctor decides.

The AI does

- Transcribe and translate voice notes
- Fill check-in fields, keeping the family’s exact words
- Ask a button follow-up when an answer is unclear
- Check that a photo is sharp and well lit
- Find the matching approved care card

The AI never

- Decides how urgent something is
- Interprets a symptom, wound or photo
- Calculates a prognosis or risk score
- Writes medical advice in its own words
- Names a drug that is not on the prescription

Every alert is traceable: the family’s words, the extracted field, the rule and its version, and who responded and when.

Opioids stay lawful: teleconsult prescriptions block NDPS drugs, and morphine refills stay at the patient’s registered RMI.

Built in five weeks on a ₹0 stack

Layer	Technology
Caregiver channel	WhatsApp Cloud API, Telegram Bot API, Next.js web app
Speech and language	Sarvam AI and Bhashini for Kannada, Hindi and English
Extraction	Open-weight LLM (gpt-oss via Groq), output checked against a fixed schema
Decisions	Deterministic rule engine running the physician-signed protocol
Records	Supabase Postgres in India’s FHIR R4 profiles, ready for ABHA linking
Dashboard and consults	Next.js on Vercel, Jitsi video, Leaflet with OpenStreetMap

Week 1

Data model, WhatsApp intake

Week 2

Voice to check-in, rules, escalation

Week 3

Medicine chart, care cards, videos

Week 4

Dashboard, PPI worksheet, e-prescription

Week 5

Safety evaluation, caregiver testing

What a 90-day pilot at KMC Manipal will measure

- Unplanned calls during OPD hours
- Minutes from a red flag to a doctor responding
- Long trips avoided, in km and rupees
- Regular and rescue doses logged by families
- Caregivers applying fentanyl patches correctly
- Caregiver usability score

Designed with the clinician from day one

Check-in, sedation wording and escalation rules drafted from POSS, ESAS-r and IPOS and reviewed by Dr. Rao. The first map covers Udupi district. Neurological and renal packs come next.